WE ARE M&C SAATCHI PERFORMANCE

WE CONNECT YOUR BRAND TO TODAY'S CONNECTED CONSUMERS

SOUNDCLOUD, OVERCOMING TRACKING LIMITATIONS

SoundCloud is a leading audio distribution and music sharing platform that allows users to upload, promote, and stream audio. SoundCloud runs a freemium model, where the premium subscription unlocks an ad-free experience.

SoundCloud offers both free and paid subscription services to customers. Artists such as Billie Eilish, Post Malone, Khalid and Lorde use SoundCloud services to launch music and grow their followers.

We have been working with SoundCloud since Q2 2021 in order to bring new users to the platform. Fynd Media are part of the M&C Saatchi Group and work on programmatic campaigns for many of our clients.

When Apple's App Tracking Transparency (ATT) framework was first brought into full effect in mid-2021 we approached Smadex, (a mobile Demand Side Platform) to help SoundCloud overcome tracking limitations and explore new User Acquisition strategies, supporting User Acquisition on Apple's SKAdNetwork.

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OUR APPROACH

THE BRIEF:

Drive User Acquisition of the SoundCloud app on iOS devices, ultimately focusing on install and SoundCloud Go (subscription) premium sign ups.

THE CHALLENGE:

SKAdNetwork, Apple's privacy-centric attribution alternative, only shares conversion data without revealing any user-level or device-level data.

This brought a new challenge for SoundCloud as we needed to re-establish campaigns and achieve results on iOS without utilizing and optimizing based on the device ID.

THE STRATEGY:

Smadex's new Flexible Mapping capability allows advertisers to identify which combinations of variables (creative, device, ad size, etc) perform the best while complying with Apple's privacy rules.

After a short learning period, we were able to narrow down to three exchanges with the best performance and allocate more resources for small formats.

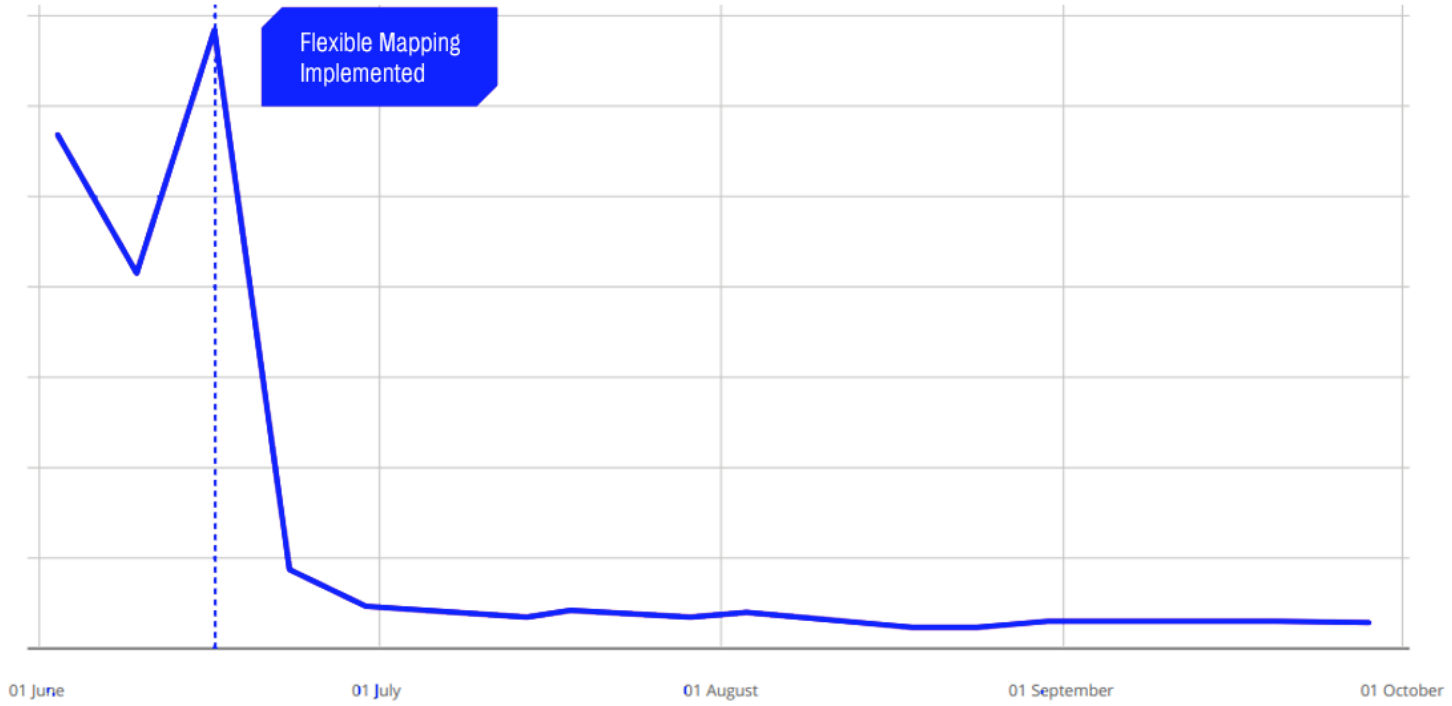
For SoundCloud's User Acquisition campaign, we mapped both exchanges and ad sizes to gain more visibility for these key criteria.

THE CAMPAIGN

Once SKAdNetwork put the new mobile programmatic framework in place, we saw a loss of user-level data and reduced visibility of post-install events, limiting our ability to optimize.

However, using Smadex's Flexible Mapping capability, we were able to successfully map both exchanges and ad sizes to gain more visibility for these key values.

The campaign then reached SoundCloud's Cost per Install Goal. From that point on, we fine-tuned optimizations, achieving an average CPI of under the 50% target for the rest of the campaign.



THE POWER OF PERFORMANCE

-53%
LOWER COST PER INSTALL

+90%
PERFORMANCE LIFT

281+
MILLION
IMPRESSIONS

When first launched on SKAdNetwork,, without previous insights, the Cost per Install was significantly above the target goal.

Thanks to Flexible Mapping we were able to faster identifying a combination of variables that achieved the best performance, shortening the learning curve and enabling faster campaign optimization.

Results June-September 2021

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TALK TO US

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